James M. Reeves

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Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Colorado Denver, 2025–Present

Affiliations

Faculty Affiliate, CU Population Center (CUPC), 2025–Present

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Michigan, 2025
M.A. in Economics, University of Colorado Denver, 2017
M.S. in Finance and Risk Management, University of Colorado Denver, 2017
B.A. in Economics/Mathematics, Western Washington University, 2015

Publications

Agency Incentives and Disparate Revenue Collection: Evidence from Chicago Parking Tickets with Elizabeth Luh and Benjamin Pyle, *Journal of Public Economics*, 261: 105736, 2026.

Gender Differences in Political Career Progression with Ryan Brown, Hani Mansour, and Stephen D. O'Connell, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, 230: 106806, 2025.

Voting and Political Participation in the Aftermath of the HIV/AIDS Epidemic with Hani Mansour, *Journal of Human Resources*, 59(6): 1769-1794, 2024.

JUE Insight: Condominium Development Does Not Lead to Gentrification with Leah P. Boustan, Robert A. Margo, Matthew M. Miller, and Justin P. Steil, *Journal of Urban Economics*, 133: 103524, 2023.

Working Papers

The Direct and Intergenerational Effects of Criminal History-Based Safety Net Bans in the U.S. with Michael Mueller-Smith, Kevin Schnepel, and Caroline Walker, *Revise and Resubmit at Journal of Political Economy*.

The Socioeconomic Consequences of Misdemeanor Conviction with Nikhil Rao.

Measuring Discrimination using Natural Experiments with Nikhil Rao.

Multitasking, Incentives, and Police Officer Behavior

Parental Job Loss and Geographic Mobility with Andrew Joung.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Job Displacement, Crime, and the Value of Unemployment Insurance in the U.S. with Itzik Fadlon, Michael Mueller-Smith, Benjamin Pyle, and Brianna Sullivan.

Examining Interventions to Improve the Outcomes of Justice-Involved Individuals with Nikhil Rao, *FSRDC Project #2957.*

GRANTS

Policy Impacts Early Career Scholars Grant (Co-PI, $10,000), 2026
Arnold Ventures (PI, $197,208), 2025-2029
Arnold Ventures (PI, $195,444), 2025-2029

HONORS AND AWARDS

John E. Parker Memorial Prize in Labor Economics and Human Resources, 2025
Department of Economics Outstanding Third Year Paper Award, 2022
Department of Economics Summer Research Award, 2020, 2021
Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship Fund Predoctoral Fellow, 2019 – 2020
University of Colorado Denver CLAS Outstanding M.A. Graduate Student, 2017
Settlemyer Family Scholarship, 2013
Western Washington University College of Business and Economics Distinguished Scholar, 2012
Western Washington University President's Scholar, 2012

PRESENTATIONS

2026: *(Including scheduled)* UC San Diego, San Diego State University CHEPS, Society of Labor Economists Annual Meeting, American Law and Economics Association Annual Meeting, Rocky Mountain Applied Microeconomics Workshop, Colorado State University, CU Denver Health and Behavioral Sciences Colloquium, APPAM Fall Research Conference, Inaugural IZA@LISER Conference in Labour Economics

2025: Cowles Foundation (Yale) - Labor and Public, Texas Economics of Crime Workshop (TxECW), Virtual Crime Economics Seminar (ViCE), University of Colorado Denver, University of Michigan, University of Texas at San Antonio

2024: NBER Children & Families Spring Meeting, Institute for Research on Poverty Summer Workshop (Wisconsin), UM-MSU-UWO Labo(u)r Day, American Law and Economics Association Annual Meeting, Western Economic Association Annual Meeting

2023: Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime, Midwestern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Kennessaw State University

2020: Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting

TEACHING

University of Colorado Denver, 2025–Present
Department of Economics

Law and Economics
Intermediate Microeconomic Theory
Seminar in Applied Economics (Ph.D./M.A.)

PRIOR RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Michigan, 2020 – 2025
Criminal Justice Administrative Records System
Graduate Student Research Assistant

Princeton University, 2017 – 2019
Industrial Relations Section
Research assistant for Leah Boustan, Will Dobbie, and Alan B. Krueger

REFEREE SERVICE

American Journal of Health Economics, American Law and Economics Review, Economic Analysis and Policy, Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, Journal of Economics, Race, and Policy, Review of Economics of the Household, The Quarterly Journal of Economics

OTHER

Citizenship: U.S.
United States Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status, 2020 – Present

Last updated: September 27, 2026